

KHADIJA ABDI

Education 607-537-1233 | ka585@cornell.edu | [linkedin.com/in/khali-abdi](https://www.linkedin.com/in/khali-abdi) | Portfolio (khaliabdi.com)

Cornell University

May 2028

Candidate for Master of Science in Human Environment Relations

Ithaca, NY

Department of Human Centered Design, Concentration in Environmental Psychology and Human Factors

Research Focus: Equity in health sensor design (cross-skin-tone accuracy) and user trust in health technology

Relevant Coursework: Human Factors & Inclusive Design, Applied Ergonomic Methods, Research Methods, AI

Embodiment & Design, Quantitative Methods I

University of Waterloo

May 2025

Bachelor of Applied Science in Chemical Engineering, Honours, Co-operative Program

Waterloo, ON

Technical Skills

Human Factors & Research Methods: Usability testing, think-aloud protocols, task analysis, workflow mapping, user interviews, heuristic evaluation, stakeholder mapping, persona and JTBD development, research ethics protocols

Analysis & Programming: Python (pandas, NumPy), MATLAB, statistical and qualitative data analysis, HTML, JavaScript, ReactJS

Design & Visualization: AutoCAD, SolidWorks, Figma, Power BI

Work Experience

Graduate Research Assistant

September 2026 – Present

Design + Augmented Intelligence Lab (DAIL)

Ithaca, NY

- Joined DAIL to research how older adults navigate and respond to built and virtual environments using AR/VR and biometric sensing.

User Experience Researcher

August 2025 – Present

Allshores Limited

Toronto, ON

- Mapped end-to-end workflows for **3 patient and provider audiences**, uncovering **10+ usability and experience pain points** that informed feature prioritization for health-related services.
- Designed and implemented **5 feedback collection methods** with Insights and Product teams, aligning stakeholders on user needs ahead of product decisions.
- Created **5 user personas** and early Jobs To Be Done (JTBD) frameworks that guided product and design decisions.

Co-Founder & Product Lead

October 2024 – June 2026

Mea (formerly Hera)

Waterloo, ON

- Built a digital support platform for postpartum mental health, translating user needs into peer connection, emotion tracking, and a personalized care guide.
- Selected for the University of Waterloo's Velocity Summer Incubator, receiving venture funding, mentorship, and dedicated product development support.
- Led customer discovery and product validation through **1,000+ survey views** and **20+ interviews** with healthcare experts and target users, using AI-assisted first-pass thematic analysis to synthesize findings into product requirements.

Associate Product Management Intern

January 2024 – August 2024

The Argus Group

Hamilton, Bermuda

- Conducted usability testing and **30+ user interviews** across service and product research initiatives, triangulating survey, interview, and observational data to identify navigation and lifecycle gaps.
- Owned formative usability testing with **10 participants**, extracting **12 actionable insights** that drove a redesign cutting navigation time by **20%** on a health benefits tool.
- Developed an MVP roadmap from research findings that secured **\$100,000** in funding and consolidated fragmented healthcare booking processes.

Projects

Oxygen-Releasing Hydrogel for Diabetic Wounds | *Final Year Capstone Project*

April 2025

- Led a **4-person team** through project scope definition, stakeholder identification, and success metrics, coordinating weekly team and supervisor meetings that kept all deliverables on **100% schedule completion**.
- Conducted a literature review on oxygen-generating hydrogel systems that helped inform the team's material selection (calcium peroxide-embedded thiolated gelatin), achieving sustained oxygen release validated at **~86%** dissolved oxygen.
- Led social, economic, and sustainability impact analysis, turning technical results into a cost model (**\$0.55–\$8.80/patch**) demonstrating feasibility for equitable deployment in low-resource care settings.